

Looking for a Free Backup Solution? Try Areca

Let's take a look at Areca Backup, which is simple, easy to use, versatile, and makes interacting with your backups easy.

Areca Backup is an open source file backup utility that comes with a lot of features, while also being easy to use. It provides a large number of backup options, which make it stand out among the various other backup utilities. This article will help you learn about its features, installation and use on the Linux platform.

Areca Backup is personal file backup software written in Java by Olivier Petrucci and released under GNU GPL v2. It's been extensively developed to run on major platforms like Windows and Linux, providing users a large number of configurable options with which to select their files and directories for backup, choose where and how to store them, set up post-backup actions and much more. This article deals with Areca on the Linux platform.

Features

To start with, it must be made clear that Areca is by no means a disk-ghosting application. That is, it will not be able to make an image of your disk partitions (as Norton Ghost does), mainly because of file permissions. Areca, along with a backup engine, includes a great GUI and CLI. It's been designed to be as simple, versatile and interactive as possible. A few of the application's features are:

- Zip/Zip64 compression and AES 128/AES 256 archive encryption algorithms
- Storage on local drive, network drive, USB key, FTP/FTPs (with implicit and explicit SSL/TLS encryption) or SFTP server
- Incremental, differential and full backup support
- Support for delta backup
- Backup filters (by extension, sub-directory, regexp, size, date, status and usage)
- Archive merges
- As of date recovery
- Backup reports
- Tools to help you handle your archives easily and efficiently, such as Backup, Archive Recovery, Archive Merge, Archive Deletion, Archive Explorer, History Explorer



Installation

Areca is developed in Java, so you need to have the Java Virtual Machine v1.4 or higher already installed and running on your system. You can verify this by checking it in the command-line:

```
$ java -version
```

In case you come up with a false result, you can download and install it from <http://java.sun.com/javase/downloads/index.jsp>

To install Areca, you need to download the latest release from http://sourceforge.net/project/showfiles.php?group_id=171505 and retrieve its contents on your disk. To make Areca executable from the console, go to the extracted Areca directory and run the commands given below:

```
$ chmod a+x areca.sh areca_check_version.sh
$ chmod a+x -v bin/*
```